

Question 60 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate two alternative training programs for the same organisational need using the Kirkpatrick model and recommend the more effective program.

Answer

Organisational need: first-line supervisors must learn to give developmental feedback (linked to HRD climate). Two alternatives are evaluated.

- 1. Programme A – Two-day off-site lecture on ‘leadership’ with motivational speaker.** Likely high Level 1 (reaction). Level 2 uncertain (few skill practices). Level 3 weak (no on-job tools). Level 4 unlikely (climate/appraisal unchanged).
- 2. Programme B – TNA-based blended design:** concept module, extensive role play, real feedback assignments, boss-as-coach, 60-day follow-up, appraisal item on coaching quality.
- 3. Level 1:** A may beat B (entertainment). B still adequate if relevant.
- 4. Level 2:** B superior due to practice and feedback on skill.
- 5. Level 3:** B superior due to assignments and climate support; A rarely transfers.
- 6. Level 4:** B more likely to improve employee development climate, error correction and engagement; A is costly with little result.
- 7. Recommendation:** Choose Programme B even if reaction scores are slightly lower.
- 8. Condition:** B must keep quality facilitation and management support; otherwise it also fails at level 3.

Conclusion. Using Kirkpatrick, the more effective programme is the one that can reach behaviour and results, not the one that only maximises participant happiness.